

GERT8000-T3 ERTMS Rule Book



Possession of an ERTMS
running line for engineering
work where lineside signals
are not provided

Issue 4.1



Module T3
ERTMS

November 2022
Comes into force 03 December 2022

Conventions used in the Rule Book

	Example
A black line in the margin indicates a change to that rule when published for the first time, and will then appear until the module is reissued.	
Green text in the margin indicates who is responsible for carrying out the rule.	
A white i in a blue box indicates that there is information provided at the bottom of the page.	
A rule printed inside a red box is considered to be critical and is therefore emphasised in this way.	

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You will need this module if, on ERTMS lines, you carry out the duties of a:

- driver
- signaller.

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1

Possession details

The person responsible: signaller

1.1 Possession details to be published

Except when a possession must be taken in an urgent situation, details of the possession must be published in the *Weekly Operating Notice* or *Engineering Notice*.

signaller

1.2 Changing the possession limits

The limits of the possession may be shortened or lengthened as long as:

signaller

- the details of the changed limits, including the planned time, are published in the *Weekly Operating Notice* or *Engineering Notice*, or
- in exceptional circumstances, it is agreed by Operations Control. You must record the details in the Train Register.

1.3 Changes to published details

Operations Control will let you and the person in charge of the possession (PICOP) know if it is necessary for any of the published details to be changed.

signaller

2

Taking the possession

The person responsible: signaller

2.1 PICOP confirming the details

signaller

The PICOP will contact the signaller who controls the block marker leading to the section of line that is to be taken under possession and will state the published possession reference if there is one.

If you are that signaller, you and the PICOP must agree:

- the line that will be taken under possession
- the possession procedure to be used
- whether the possession is to be taken around one or more trains
- the locations between which the possession will be taken including the protecting block markers or points
- the details of any points or crossings that may be used for trains outside the possession
- the position that points within the possession must be placed in
- the arrangements to be applied for each level crossing within the possession
- the exact location of the first work-site marker board (WSMB) in the normal direction of travel
- the exact location of the last WSMB in the normal direction of travel
- the time the possession is to be taken and the time it will be given up.

2.2 Taking the possession around one or more engineering trains

signaller

When the possession is to be taken or lengthened around an engineering train, you must signal the train concerned normally to the block marker specified in the notices.

When the engineering train arrives at the specified block marker, you must tell the driver not to move the engineering train again until given instructions by the PICOP, engineering supervisor (ES) or safe work leader (SWL) after the possession has been granted.

signaller

When every engineering train is at its specified block marker you must tell the PICOP.

You must record the details in the Train Register.

2.3 Arranging to block the line

Protecting the line with block markers

Each entrance to the section of line on which the possession is taken must be protected by a block marker in the normal direction of travel.

signaller

On a single or bi-directional line, each exit from the section of line on which the possession is taken must be protected by a block marker.

On a line that is not single or bi-directional, each exit from the line on which a possession is taken must be protected by a block marker in the normal direction of travel.

The distance between the block marker or points used to protect the entrance to the possession and the first WSMB must not be less than 200 metres.

The block marker immediately beyond the last WSMB must be no closer than 200 metres. This must be the point where normal working starts for train movements in the right direction.

Closing the route

When the section of line concerned is clear other than any trains at a stand, as shown in section 2.2 or when the possession is to be taken for the purpose of removing derailed vehicles or any other obstruction, the following must apply.

signaller

You must make sure the routes are closed from the block markers you have agreed will protect the possession.

signaller

You must also make sure all points are in the position necessary to protect the possession.

You must record the details in the Train Register. You must also close:

- all routes within the possession
- all other routes which lead to or across the possession.

You must then ask a competent person, if present in the signal box, to check that this has been done correctly.

If another signaller is involved

If any protecting block markers are controlled by another signaller, you must get confirmation from that signaller that the routes from the protecting block markers have been closed and will be kept closed until the possession is given up.

If any signallers at other signal boxes are involved with the possession arrangements, you must:

- tell them what the possession arrangements are
- get their assurance that they will keep to these arrangements.

signaller

If you are the signaller at another signal box and you are told about the possession arrangements, you must record in the Train Register:

- which line is blocked
- the limits of the possession
- the block markers at which you must keep the routes closed to protect the possession
- the points you must operate to protect the possession
- the position that points within the possession must be placed in.

Telling the PICOP

When all the routes have been closed to protect the possession, you must tell the PICOP who will then complete section 1 of the Possession Arrangements Form (RT3198 ERTMS). The PICOP will then read the details back to you.

When you are satisfied that all the details on the PICOP's RT3198 ERTMS form are correct, you must tell the PICOP that the possession protection procedure can be carried out.

If any unworked points need to be secured, the PICOP is responsible for arranging for this to be done.



2.4 When signalling protection has been provided

When protection by block markers and points has been provided as shown in section 2.3 of this module, one of the following possession procedures must be carried out before the possession can be granted.

signaller

The only exception to this is possession procedure T3-A. This procedure must be carried out after the possession is granted.

You must record in the Train Register which possession procedure has been used.

2.5 Possession procedure T3-A (using a track circuit operating device T-COD)

You may use procedure T3-A only if all of the following apply.

signaller

- Use of a T-COD is authorised at the location concerned.
- The signalling equipment is working normally at the time the T-COD is to be placed on the line.
- The work within the possession will not affect the correct operation of the track circuit concerned.

The PICOP will arrange for the T-COD to be placed after the possession has been granted.

Before giving the PICOP permission to place the T-COD, you must make sure the track circuit concerned is showing clear. You must tell the PICOP when the track circuit concerned shows occupied.

2.6 Possession procedure T3-D (disconnecting signalling equipment)

a) When this procedure can be used

You may use procedure T3-D only if it is authorised at the particular location.

signaller

b) Arranging for a disconnection to be made

When you have told the PICOP all routes leading towards the possession have been closed, as shown in section 2.3 of this module, the PICOP will arrange for the signalling controls of these routes to be disconnected.

The PICOP will tell you when this has been done.

2.7 Possession procedure T3-P (PICOP or PICOP's agent going to the signal box)

a) When this procedure may be used

signaller

You may use procedure T3-P only if it is authorised at the particular location.

b) PICOP going to the signal box

When you have told the PICOP all routes protecting the entrances and exits from the possession have been closed as shown in section 2.3 of this module, the PICOP will check that this has been done and that the possession is being correctly protected.

If the PICOP cannot personally attend the signal box that controls the routes protecting the entrances to and exits from the possession, the PICOP will arrange for a PICOP's agent to be in the controlling signal box to check that the correct routes have been closed.

If possession procedure T3-P is being used, you must not grant the possession until the PICOP or the PICOP's agent is present and the PICOP is satisfied that the possession is correctly protected.

2.8 Possession procedure T3-E (barring the route)

signaller

Possession procedure T3-E **must** always be used except when it is not possible to do so and one of the alternative procedures has been agreed at the planning meeting.

In exceptional circumstances, this may be agreed by Operations Control.

signaller

When you have told the PICOP all routes leading towards the possession have been closed as shown in section 2.3 of this module, the PICOP will arrange for the signalling controls of these routes to be barred.

The PICOP will tell you when this has been done.

2.9 Granting the possession

You must only grant possession when:

signaller

- signalling protection has been provided
- any additional protection required under possession procedure T3-D or T3-E has been carried out and the PICOP has recorded the details in section 2 of the Possession Arrangements Form (RT 3198 ERTMS)
- the necessary entries have been made in the Train Register.

When you are sure all these requirements have been carried out, you may tell the PICOP the possession is granted.

2.10 Changing the limits of the possession after the possession has been granted

If it is necessary to set up another work site on the approach to the first WSMB or beyond the last WSMB, the PICOP will first ask your permission to do so.

signaller

The PICOP must tell you the exact location (mileage or kilometres and metres) of the new WSMB before allowing any further train movements.

You must not give the PICOP permission to set up another work site until any movement already authorised has passed clear of the area concerned.

You must record the details of the new WSMB in the Train Register.

signaller

If possession procedure T3-A is being used, the PICOP must make sure a T-COD is placed on the line at the same time and at the same place as the new first WSMB, as shown in section 2.5.

The PICOP will also, if necessary, arrange to remove the T-COD placed at the previous first WSMB.

2.11 Carrying out signalling work in the possession

signaller

You must not allow signalling work to be carried out if it would affect the route barring or the functioning of the balises protecting the exits from a possession.

3

Arrangements at level crossings

The person responsible: signaller

The PICOP must not allow any train or OTP movements to take place, or any work to be carried out, that will affect the operation of any level crossing until the necessary arrangements have been put in place for that level crossing.

signaller

You must reach a clear understanding with the PICOP about the arrangements that will apply at each level crossing.

You must record in the Train Register the arrangements that are applied for each level crossing within the possession.

As well as the instructions shown in module TS9 *Level crossings - signallers' regulations*, you must:

- tell any crossing keeper who will be affected by the possession arrangements
- tell the PICOP when an attendant is appointed or withdrawn at a level crossing.

4

Train movements

The person responsible: signaller

4.1 Passing the protecting block marker

signaller

You must not set any route leading to the possession.

You must not allow any train other than an ERTMS-fitted train to make a movement from either end towards the first or last WSMB.

When an engineering train is to enter a possession, you must dictate written order No.1 (RTWO01) and authorise the driver to pass the block marker and proceed to the first WSMB.

You must get permission from the PICOP before doing this.

4.2 Propelling

signaller

You must not allow any of the following movements to be propelled unless the details are published in the *Weekly Operating Notice* or *Engineering Notice*.

- Movements entering the possession.
- Movements leaving the possession.

If it is necessary to propel when details have not been published, you must get authority from Operations Control before you can allow any of the above movements to be propelled.

4.3 Entering the possession at the first WSMB

signaller

Before you give the driver permission to proceed towards the first WSMB, you must make sure:

- the PICOP has given you permission, and
- you have not authorised a conflicting movement.

When the engineering train has entered the possession, the PICOP will tell you when the first WSMB has been replaced.

signaller

4.4 Entering a possession at an intermediate point

Before you give the driver permission to proceed from the protecting block marker towards the possession, you must make sure:

signaller

- the PICOP has given you permission
- the PICOP has positioned someone at the intermediate point to give instructions to the driver
- you have not authorised a conflicting movement to take place.

You must tell the driver to stop and get instructions from the person at the intermediate point.

The PICOP will tell you when the engineering train has entered the possession and is clear of the points or crossings at the intermediate point.

You must then return the points to the agreed position.

4.5 Entering the possession from an adjacent siding under possession

If a movement is to enter the possession from an adjacent siding under possession, you must first agree with the PICOP and the person in charge of the siding possession (PICOS) how this is to be done.

signaller

4.6 Leaving the possession

You must not allow any engineering train other than an

signaller

ERTMS-fitted engineering train to make a movement between the last WSMB and the block marker protecting the exit from the possession.

signaller

When the PICOP tells you that an engineering train is ready to leave the possession, you must reach a clear understanding with the PICOP about the instructions to give the driver about the movement:

- beyond the WSMB out of the possession, or
- through points or crossings that are protecting the possession at an intermediate point.

You must make sure that the line is clear throughout to the next block marker and safe for the movement to proceed before you give the PICOP instructions to authorise the driver to pass beyond the WSMB and out of the possession.

To protect the possession, after the movement has left it, you must:

- restore to their original position all points that you have operated for the movement
- close the route protecting the exit from the possession.

4.7 Leaving the possession directly into a siding under possession

signaller

If a movement is to leave the possession directly into an adjacent siding under possession, you must first agree with the PICOP and the PICOS how this is to be done.

5

Movements over level crossings

*The person responsible: **signaller***

5.1 When these instructions apply

You must apply the instructions shown in sections 5.2 to 5.11 as appropriate when authorising a movement to enter or leave the possession.

signaller

Where the ES, PICOP or SWL is responsible for authorising the movement, the following will apply.

AHBC

The ES, PICOP or SWL will get your permission before allowing an engineering train to pass over an AHBC that is not being locally controlled.

You must not give this permission if you are aware of any reason why the train must not pass over the level crossing.

OTP will not be allowed to pass over an AHBC level crossing unless it is being locally controlled.

CCTV, OD or RC

If the crossing is not being locally controlled, the ES, PICOP or SWL will get your confirmation that the barriers have been lowered and the crossing is clear before they authorise the movement to pass over the level crossing.

5.2 Before making a movement

Before the movement takes place you must give details of the movement to those personnel operating:

signaller

- any CCTV, OD or RC level crossing
- other level crossing, if possible.

5.3 AHBC locally controlled

signaller

You must tell the driver that the movement must not pass over the level crossing unless the crossing attendant is displaying a green handsignal.

5.4 AHBC that is not locally controlled

signaller

Only an engineering train that is to pass normally over the level crossing in a direction that has controls may be allowed to proceed over the level crossing.

You must tell the driver not to stop specially before passing over the level crossing.

5.5 CCTV, OD or RC locally controlled

signaller

You must tell the driver that the movement must not pass over the level crossing unless the crossing attendant is displaying a green handsignal.

5.6 CCTV, OD or RC that is not locally controlled

signaller

You must not allow any movement in the wrong direction to pass over the level crossing.

For other movements, you must not authorise the driver to pass the block marker protecting the level crossing until the barriers have been lowered for the movement.

You must then tell the driver not to stop specially at the level crossing.

5.7 AOCL or ABCL not switched off

If the level crossing has not been switched off as shown in module TS9 *Level Crossings - signallers' regulations*, regulation 4.1, the following must apply.

signaller

You must instruct the driver of a train that is to pass over the level crossing normally, to proceed over the crossing only when it is safe to do so.

For any train movements not passing normally over the level crossing, you must not allow the movement to take place unless:

- the level crossing has been closed to road traffic, or
- a competent person is positioned at the level crossing and has stopped road traffic by displaying a red handsignal on both sides of the level crossing.

You must instruct the driver to stop at the level crossing, sound the horn and then pass over the level crossing only when it is safe to do so.

5.8 AOCL or ABCL that has been switched off

If the level crossing has been switched off as shown in module TS9 *Level crossings - signallers' regulations*, regulation 4.1, the following must apply.

signaller

During daylight

You must instruct the driver of a train that is to pass over the level crossing to stop the train at the level crossing, sound the horn and then pass over the level crossing only it is safe to do so.

signaller

During darkness

The movement of a train over the level crossing must not take place unless:

- the level crossing has been closed to road traffic, or
- a competent person is positioned at the level crossing and has stopped road traffic by displaying a red handsignal on both sides of the level crossing.

You must instruct the driver to stop at the level crossing, sound the horn and then pass over the level crossing only when it is safe to do so.

| 5.9 Manually-controlled level crossing

signaller

You must instruct the driver to pass over the level crossing only if the level crossing barriers or gates are closed to road traffic.

If it is a traincrew-operated (TMO) level crossing, you must make sure that a competent person is available to operate the level crossing before authorising the driver to proceed.

5.10 Crossing with red and green warning lights (R/G)

signaller

You must instruct the driver to stop at the level crossing, sound the horn and then pass over the level crossing only when it is safe to do so.

5.11 Barrow or foot crossing with white light indicators

signaller

You must instruct the driver to pass over the level crossing only when it is safe to do so.

6

Change of personnel

The person responsible: signaller

6.1 Change of PICOP

The PICOP will tell you the name of the new PICOP if there is a change. You must record the details in the Train Register.

signaller

6.2 Change of signaller

If you are the new signaller taking duty you must countersign the entries in the Train Register.

signaller

7

Giving up the possession

The person responsible: signaller

7.1 Giving up the possession around an engineering train

signaller

The PICOP may give up the possession with an engineering train standing at a block marker on the line under possession, as long as all of the following apply.

- The train is standing at a location where the train detection is by means of track circuits and not by axle counters.
- The movement, after the possession is given up, will be in the normal signalled direction and will be driven from the leading cab.
- You have agreed with the PICOP the block marker to be used.

When the train arrives at the agreed block marker, you must:

- tell the driver to make no further movement until you have given verbal permission for the engineering train to proceed, then
- tell the PICOP the train has arrived at the agreed block marker and will not be moved.

You must not start the arrangements to give up the possession until the engineering train has arrived at the agreed block marker.

7.2 Removing the protection

When the possession is no longer needed the PICOP will:

- if single line working is in operation, tell the pilot that the possession is being given up
- arrange to release any unworked points or train-operated points that have been secured
- arrange for any disconnection made under possession procedure T3-D to be reconnected or for any route barring carried out under possession procedure T3-E to be restored
- arrange for the first and last WSMBs to be removed.

signaller

7.3 Signaller being told when the possession is no longer needed

The PICOP will tell you that the line is clear and safe for trains to run on (or if section 7.1 applies, clear and safe other than the train standing at the agreed block marker) when:

- any unworked points or train-operated points that had been secured have been released
- any disconnection made under possession procedure T3-D has been reconnected or any route-barring carried out under possession procedure T3-E has been restored
- the first and last WSMBs have been removed.

signaller

7.4 Confirming the possession is given up

You must record the details in the Train Register. You must read the entry back to the PICOP.

signaller

When the entry has been made in the Train Register and if the PICOP agrees with the entry, this is confirmation that the possession has been given.

8

Resuming normal working

The person responsible: signaller

8.1 Restoring the signalling to normal working

signaller

When the PICOP has given up the possession, you must arrange for all routes which have been closed to be restored to normal working.

8.2 Telling personnel the possession is given up

signaller

You must tell the following that the possession has been given up.

- Any other signaller concerned.
- Any crossing keeper concerned.

If you are the signaller at an adjacent signal box, you must record the details in the Train Register.

8.3 AHBC, CCTV, OD or RC level crossings

signaller

You must arrange for normal working to be restored at any AHBC, CCTV, OD or RC level crossing at which an attendant is appointed.

8.4 Possession given up around an engineering train

signaller

If the possession was given up with an engineering train standing at a block marker, you must tell the driver of that train that the possession has been given up and the conditions under which the train may proceed.

8.5 First train over the affected portion of line

You must specially watch the operation of the track circuits during the passage of the first train over the line that was affected by the possession.

signaller

You must not allow a second train to pass over the line that was affected by the possession unless there is a route setting position (RSP) at which the route is closed between the first and second trains.

9

Driver's duties

The person responsible: driver

9.1 Authority for movement of engineering trains

driver

You must make movements only on the authority of the following personnel.

a) Signaller

The signaller will **personally** authorise you to make a movement that is required to:

- proceed from either end towards the first WSMB
- enter the possession at an intermediate point where your train will be met.

The signaller will give the PICOP the necessary instructions to pass on to you when you are to make a movement that must:

- pass through points or crossings that are protecting the possession at an intermediate point when leaving the possession
- proceed beyond the last WSMB when leaving the possession.

All movements described in section 9.1 a) are restricted to engineering trains fitted with ERTMS and operating in SR mode.

Any engineering train not fitted with ERTMS, or with ERTMS not working, must be operated by a traction unit that is fitted with ERTMS.

b) PICOP

The PICOP (or competent person on the PICOP's behalf) will authorise you to make a movement that is required to:

driver

- pass through points or crossings that are protecting the possession at an intermediate point when entering the possession
- enter or leave the possession from or to a siding that is also under possession
- pass the WSMB at the exit from a work site; this will be showing two yellow flashing lights
- move between work sites
- proceed beyond the last WSMB after passing on the signaller's instructions when leaving the possession.

You do not need a written order to leave a possession at a WSMB or at an intermediate point. However, you must be prepared to stop at the next block marker unless an MA is received.

The PICOP will wear an armband on the left arm, or a badge on the upper body, with PERSON I.C. POSSESSION in red letters on a yellow background.

Within the protection of the first and last WSMBs, all movements may be made by any engineering train or OTP.

c) ES or SWL

The ES or SWL (or a competent person on the ES's or SWL's behalf) will authorise you to make a movement:

driver

- past a WSMB into a work site; this will be showing two flashing red lights
- within a work site.

The ES can permit a person to travel in your cab to give you instructions about the working of your train while loading or unloading.

driver The ES will wear an armlet on the left arm, or a badge on the upper body, with 'ENGINEERING SUPERVISOR' shown in blue letters on a yellow background.

driver The SWL will wear an armlet on the left arm, or a badge on the upper body, with SWL in blue letters on a yellow background.

9.2 Reaching a clear understanding with others

driver You must reach a clear understanding with the person authorising the movement as to:

- what you must do
- how far the movement is to proceed.

9.3 Headlights and tail lamps

driver If the train is detained between two work sites, you must make sure that:

- a red light is showing at both ends of the train
- the headlights are switched off.

9.4 Indicating work sites within the possession

driver A WSMB will be placed in the 'four-foot' at each end of the work site. See diagram T3.1 ERTMS.

The WSMB for one work site will be no closer than 100 metres from the WSMB of another work site.

WSMBs are not needed if there will be no engineering train or OTP movements within the possession.

Only the ES can give authority for your train to pass the WSMB displaying two red lights and enter the work site.

Only the PICOP can give authority for your train to pass the WSMB displaying two yellow lights and leave a work site.

driver

9.5 During the movement

a) Making the movement

You must make the movement at caution and not exceed 40 km/h (25 mph) at any point in the journey when entering, making a movement within, or leaving the possession.

driver

The PICOP, when authorising the movement between work sites, will tell you the location of any permissible or temporary speed restriction lower than 40 km/h (25 mph) on the portion of line concerned and you must not exceed these speeds.

You must:

- make any movement in a work site at not more than 10 km/h (5 mph) unless you are given specific instructions by the ES or SWL on the maximum speed to be applied
- be prepared to stop before reaching a handsignal that is being displayed.

You can use GSM-R radio to speak at any time about details of the movement being made.

You must also carry out the instructions shown in module S5 *Passing a signal at danger or an end of authority (EoA) without a movement authority (MA)* or TW7 *Wrong-direction movements*.

When vehicles are being loaded or unloaded, you must also carry out the instructions shown in module SS2 *Shunting*.

b) Passing a block marker within the possession

You must not pass a block marker within the possession unless you are authorised to do so by the PICOP or by the ES or SWL if it is within a work site. In this case you do not need a written order.

c) Level crossings

driver

You must not pass over any level crossing unless you have been instructed to do so.

When you pass over the crossing, you must carry out the relevant instructions regarding level crossings shown in module S5 *Passing a signal at danger or an end of authority (EoA) without a movement authority (MA) or TW7 Wrong-direction movements*.

9.6 When a possession is to be taken around one or more engineering trains

a) Conditions

driver

If the arrangements have been published, the signaller can grant a possession to the PICOP when your train is standing at a block marker on the line on which the possession is to be taken.

The block marker this applies to will be shown in the *Weekly Operating Notice* or *Engineering Notice*.

b) Proceeding to the specified block marker

Your movement to the specified block marker will be signalled under normal arrangements.

c) Arriving at the specified block marker

When your train arrives at the specified block marker, the signaller will instruct you to make no further movement until you are authorised by the PICOP, ES or SWL, as appropriate.

9.7 When a possession is to be given up around an engineering train

a) Conditions

The PICOP can give up the possession with one engineering train standing at a specified block marker on the line under possession as long as:

- the movement, after the possession is given up, will be in the normal signalled direction, and
- the movement must be driven from the leading cab.

If the possession is to be given up around your train, the PICOP will tell you the location and identity of the block marker you must stop at.

This block marker will be agreed between the PICOP and the signaller and must not be within a work site.

The PICOP will also tell you and anyone else on the train, that the line on which you are standing must be considered as no longer under possession.

b) Arriving at the block marker

When your train arrives at the block marker, you must immediately contact the signaller. You must make no further movement with the train until the signaller tells you to proceed.

c) When the possession has been given up

When the possession has been given up, the signaller will tell you this and the conditions under which the train may proceed.

driver

Notes

Uncontrolled when printed

Point release published on 19/11/2022 supersedes GERT8000-T3 ERTMS Iss 4
and comes into force on 03/12/2022

Notes



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